MAGI

CLAUDE.MD · PROJECT GUIDANCE STARTER · VERSION 0.1

Purpose

This document gives an AI coding assistant a small set of durable project principles. Keep it lightweight. Update it as the product becomes clearer; do not treat early assumptions as permanent rules.

Project summary

Magi is a minimalist effects tool library for experimenting with visual effects on live camera input or uploaded media, then saving the result to the user's device. The first release focuses on the Bitmap effect.

Current product priorities

- Build a working Bitmap experience before expanding the effects library.
- Support live camera input and uploaded photos/videos.
- Bitmap uses square pixels and pure black and white only; perceived gray comes from pixel distribution and density.
- Provide Scale and Intensity controls, a medium default Scale, and a reset-to-defaults action.
- Keep the interface black and white, minimal, and unobtrusive.
- Use uniform rectangular text-only effect tiles; do not add thumbnails unless the product direction changes.
- Keep the bottom toolbar simple, fixed, and icon-based without text labels.
- Support capture, retake, and saving/downloading results.

Implementation principles

- Prefer modular components and keep each effect's implementation separate from the main camera interface.
- Make shared controls reusable and consistent where practical.
- Keep effect configuration (names, defaults, and parameters) separate from effect rendering logic where this improves maintainability.
- Build incrementally and verify each major interaction before adding complexity.
- Preserve responsive behavior across desktop and mobile browsers.
- Do not introduce dependencies, abstractions, or features without a clear need.

Design principles

- Prioritize clarity, restraint, and functional simplicity.
- Use a black-and-white visual system and neutral typography; Inter is the current starting point, not an unchangeable requirement.
- Let the visual effects carry the personality. Avoid unnecessary labels, decoration, and interface noise.
- Take inspiration from minimalist fashion/editorial design philosophies without copying another brand's identity.

Working style for the coding assistant

- Before making broad changes, inspect the existing project structure and explain the intended approach briefly.
- Prefer small, reversible changes over large rewrites.
- Ask a question only when a missing decision blocks safe or useful progress; otherwise use a reasonable, clearly stated assumption.
- Do not silently invent product requirements. Flag meaningful trade-offs and unresolved decisions.
- Keep documentation aligned with the actual implementation; update this file when durable project conventions change.

Flexibility rule

These guidelines are a starting point, not a rigid specification. Product decisions may change during prototyping. Favor consistency when it helps, but do not preserve a rule merely because it appears here. The PRD is the current source for product scope; this file guides implementation behavior.

Current planned effects

1. Bitmap — first release
2. ASI Symbols
3. Binary
4. X's and O's

Open decisions

Exact effect algorithms and parameter ranges, depth estimation, export details, responsive layout specifics, and the long-term Effect Lab architecture remain open. Prototype first; document decisions when they become durable.

Maintenance: Keep this file concise. Add rules only when they are repeatedly useful or prevent a real implementation mistake.